



MANAGER VOYAGE · THE FOUR-WEEK COHORT

The Manager *Playbook*.

Your written personal operating system: how you manage, in your own words, one section a week. Drafted through the four weeks, presented at the capstone, and yours to keep.

NAME

TEAM AND BUSINESS UNIT

COHORT

KICKOFF DATE

How this Playbook works

Every week of the cohort ends with a Playbook section. The Friday discussion is grounded in what you wrote, and the capstone is where you present the whole thing.

The weekly rhythm

BY MONDAY Core module A LinkedIn Learning course in Oracle Learning sets the topic and the vocabulary. Released at the close of the previous Friday, so it is prework for the week it serves. 45 to 60 min	TUESDAY OR WEDNESDAY Learning Lab in SparkWise A facilitated small-group peer lab on the same topic, working a live case from someone's real team. 45 min, live	THURSDAY Scenario Studio in Yoodli The week's conversation, rehearsed with an AI counterpart grounded in Vanderbilt policy. From week 2. 15 min	FRIDAY Manager Voyage discussion FLH-facilitated. What happened when you tried it, what your Playbook section says now, what you commit to next week. 30 min, virtual; 60 in weeks 1 and 4
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What you write, week by week

WHEN	SECTION	DUE
Pework	The first sentence of your Philosophy, the confidence pulse, and the calendar holds.	Bring it to the kickoff
Week 1	Section 1 · Manager Philosophy. What your team can expect from you, what you say when bad news lands, your 90-day intent.	Sunday
Week 2	Section 2 · 1:1 framework and conversation plan. Your cadence and agenda, three goals per person, the conversation you rehearsed.	Sunday
Week 3	Section 3 · Delegation and growth plan. Where each person wants to be, one stretch assignment, the rung they are on, your coaching cadence.	Sunday
Week 4	Section 4 · Performance practice, then the Integrated Management Model and the Team Development Plan.	Before the capstone

Three rules for writing it

Write in your own voice. This is not a form for PCB; it is the document you will reread in month six. **Use real names and real dates.** A plan without a name and a date is a wish. **Short beats complete.** One true sentence per prompt is enough; the discussion adds the rest.

Where it ends up

At the capstone you present the Integrated Management Model and the Team Development Plan to peers and your business unit leader, in the room or online. The deliverables are recorded in Oracle Learning against your job profile. The Playbook stays with you.

The six standards

Six behaviors, drawn from Gary Yukl (2012), one standard for every manager. The Foundation course taught the habits behind each; this Playbook is where you practice them with your real team.

STANDARD	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	WHERE THE PLAYBOOK BUILDS IT
Create clarity	Every person can say what they own, by when, what good looks like, and why it matters.	Sections 1 and 2
Coach and develop	Regular 1:1s, feedback while the work can still change, and a growth move for each person.	Sections 2 and 3, Team Development Plan
Build trust	People bring bad news early, are thanked by name, and are heard before decisions land.	Section 1
Empower others	Decisions handed over with the boundary stated, small trials allowed, and not taken back.	Section 3
Address issues	Missed work named the week it happens, causes found, concerns routed the same day.	Sections 2 and 4
Lead change	The why explained in your own words, a picture of next year, and a look back after big work.	Team Development Plan

How the four weeks build them

WEEK	TOPIC	BUILDS
Week 1	What it means to manage. Establishes the why before the how. By Friday you can say, in one sentence, what your team can expect from you.	Create clarity · Build trust
Week 2	Goal setting, 1:1s, and difficult conversations. Builds daily operating discipline. By Friday you have a 1:1 cadence on the calendar, three goals per person drafted, and one hard conversation held.	Create clarity · Coach and develop · Address issues
Week 3	Coaching and mentoring. Shifts you from directing to developing. By Friday you have handed over one real decision and held one coaching conversation that was mostly questions.	Coach and develop · Empower others
Week 4	Performance management and developing talent. Closes the loop from learning to leading. At the capstone you present a finished Playbook, a one-page Integrated Management Model, and a 90-day Team Development Plan.	Coach and develop · Address issues · Lead change

How you are measured

You rate yourself on all six before the kickoff and again at the capstone, on the next pages. The Manager Effectiveness Assessment you took before the Foundation course scores the same habits; you retake it six months after the capstone.

W0 Prework

Watch New Manager Foundations in Oracle Learning, then write one sentence. Bring it to the kickoff; you will read it aloud.

The first sentence of your Philosophy

What can your team expect from you? One sentence. It will be sharpened in week 1.

The pulse, before

One item per standard. How often is this true of you today? Circle one. You answer the same six again at the capstone, and the six-month assessment scores the same habits.

STANDARD	NOT YET	EVERY WEEK
Create clarity. Each person on my team can state their priorities, deadlines, and what good looks like.	123	45
Coach and develop. I hold a coaching conversation, mostly questions, with each person at least monthly.	123	45
Build trust. My team tells me bad news early, and I thank people specifically, by name, that week.	123	45
Empower others. I have handed a real decision to a team member this month and did not take it back.	123	45
Address issues. When work or conduct slips, I name it within the week, specifically and without hinting.	123	45
Lead change. My team can explain, in their own words, why the current change is happening.	123	45

Before the kickoff

- ☐ New Manager Foundations watched in Oracle Learning
- ☐ The calendar holds accepted: the Learning Lab slot, the Scenario Studio, and the Friday discussion, all four weeks
- ☐ The kickoff date, time, and room or link confirmed
- ☐ The first sentence above written and ready to read aloud

Which of the four jobs have you been avoiding? Get the work done through your team · Take care of your people · Make things better · Connect your team. Name it here; it becomes your thread through the four weeks.

01 Manager Philosophy

One page on how you will manage. Start from the sentence you read aloud at the kickoff and the reaction you named in the Learning Lab.

BUILDS: CREATE CLARITY · BUILD TRUST

What my team can expect from me

Three commitments, in plain words. The ones you could be held to on a bad day.

What I say when bad news lands

Your first sentence, word for word. Thank first, solve second, learn the cause later.

The one reaction on my team I will change

From the Learning Lab: the moment that decides whether you hear the next problem early.

My intent for the next 90 days

What will be true about this team by Day 90 that is not true today?

Friday discussion prompt. Read your commitments to a peer. They answer: what would your team notice by Friday if that were true? Write their answer here.

02 1:1 framework and conversation plan

The operating discipline of the role: a cadence on the calendar, goals per person, and the hard conversation you rehearsed in the Scenario Studio and then held for real.

BUILDS: CREATE CLARITY · COACH AND DEVELOP · ADDRESS ISSUES

My 1:1 framework

Cadence and length

Weekly or biweekly, how long, which day. It goes on the calendar before Monday.

Where the agenda lives

Theirs first. Where it is written so both of you can see it.

What I check every time

Work before it is due, what they are stuck on, what is coming that they should hear from me first.

What I never let a 1:1 become

A status report, a one-way download, a skipped meeting.

Three goals per person, this quarter

NAME	GOAL 1	GOAL 2	GOAL 3	BY WHEN

The conversation plan

Who, and what I noticed

The specific observation, with dates. Not a feeling about them.

What I expect, by when

Clear is kind. The expectation and the date, said out loud.

My opening sentence, word for word

What they might need from me

The question you will ask, and the help you can actually give.

What happened when I held it

Fill in after. One minute, for Friday: what you said, what they said, what you would say differently.

03 Delegation and growth plan

From directing to developing: where each person wants to go, one stretch assignment toward it, the rung of the ladder they are on, and the decision you handed over this week.

BUILDS: COACH AND DEVELOP · EMPOWER OTHERS

The delegation ladder

1 · Do as I say I decide, they do.	2 · Check with me They propose, I approve.	3 · Tell me, then act They decide and inform me first.	4 · Act, then tell me They decide and inform me after.	5 · Their call They decide; I hear about it if it matters.
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Growth plan, one line per person

NAME	WHERE THEY WANT TO BE IN TWO YEARS	ONE STRETCH ASSIGNMENT TOWARD IT	RUNG TODAY	NEXT RUNG	BY WHEN

The decision I handed over this week

The decision, and to whom

The decision, not just the task.

The one boundary I stated

The thing the decision has to respect, said once, up front.

What happened when I did not take it back

For Friday. Include the moment you wanted to.

My coaching cadence

When you ask instead of tell: which meeting, how often, with the GROW questions to hand.

Coach or correct: the case I decided

The pattern, which one it needed, and why.

04 Performance practice

How you run the cycle, how you give feedback, and how you handle a concern from the first conversation to the written step, with the people you call along the way.

BUILDS: COACH AND DEVELOP · ADDRESS ISSUES

How I run the performance cycle

Goals set and written

When in the cycle, and where the team can see them.

Check-ins

How often the goals come up before the review, so nothing at the review is a surprise.

My feedback approach

Situation, behavior, impact: my template

When you did X in Y, the effect was Z. Write the version you will actually say.

Reinforcing feedback, that week

Specific, by name, the same week. How you will make sure it happens.

A concern, from first conversation to written step

STEP	WHAT I DO	WHO I CALL
The clear conversation		Nobody yet, unless unsure: my HCM
If it does not change		My HCM, before anything formal
The written step		Employee Relations Consultant, through my HCM
A leave, health, or fairness mention along the way		Leave, EOA, or Title IX the same day

The performance conversation I rehearsed, then held

Honest about the cycle, specific about what would change the answer, a growth move that starts now.

Integrated Management Model

How the four weeks connect for you. Synthesis, not attendance: one habit per job, in your words, and the sentence at the center that holds them together.

JOB 1 · GET THE WORK DONE, THROUGH YOUR TEAM

Plan it, say it, check it, fix it

My habit, and the week it comes from:

JOB 2 · TAKE CARE OF YOUR PEOPLE

Listen and help, grow them, thank them, trust them

My habit, and the week it comes from:

JOB 3 · MAKE THINGS BETTER

Explain the why, describe where we are going, let people try, look back

My habit, and the week it comes from:

JOB 4 · CONNECT YOUR TEAM

Know the people, watch for what is coming, speak up for your team

My habit, and the week it comes from:

THE SENTENCE AT THE CENTER

How I manage, in one sentence. It should sound like the Philosophy from week 1, sharpened by three more weeks.

Team Development Plan

A plan for your actual team: names, goals, growth moves, and dates. Challenged by peers in the week 4 Learning Lab; presented at the capstone to peers and your business unit leader.

BUILDS: COACH AND DEVELOP · LEAD CHANGE

The team goal for the next 90 days

One outcome the whole team owns, and how you will know.

What I need from my business unit leader

The ask, with the reason. Bring it to the capstone.

What could get in the way

The risk you already see, and your first move on it.

The five-minute presentation

- ☐ One minute: the sentence at the center of my Integrated Management Model
- ☐ Two minutes: the team goal and one person's plan, by name
- ☐ One minute: the habit I have kept since week 1, and what changed
- ☐ One minute: what I need from my business unit leader

The capstone, and after

Before you present, take the pulse again and compare it with your prework answers. Then the six-month checkpoint.

The pulse, after

STANDARD

Create clarity. Each person on my team can state their priorities, deadlines, and what good looks like.

NOT YET

EVERY WEEK

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Coach and develop. I hold a coaching conversation, mostly questions, with each person at least monthly.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Build trust. My team tells me bad news early, and I thank people specifically, by name, that week.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Empower others. I have handed a real decision to a team member this month and did not take it back.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Address issues. When work or conduct slips, I name it within the week, specifically and without hinting.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Lead change. My team can explain, in their own words, why the current change is happening.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Capstone checklist

- ☐ Sections 1 to 4 finished
- ☐ Integrated Management Model on one page
- ☐ Team Development Plan with names and dates
- ☐ Business unit leader invited, in the room or online
- ☐ Five-minute presentation rehearsed in the Friday discussion

After the cohort

- ☐ Reread this Playbook at Day 30 and Day 90 of the plan
- ☐ Take the Manager Effectiveness Assessment again at six months and compare the score
- ☐ Keep the Manager Portal open: templates, policy links, and who to call

Manager _____

Business unit leader _____

Date _____

Vanderbilt University · People, Culture and Belonging · Futures Learning Hub. The Manager Playbook is the manager's own document. Deliverables are recorded in Oracle Learning; the Playbook itself is not collected.